

Shahi Hammam (Royal Bath) and Khilwat Khana

شاهی حمام و خلوت خانہ

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Emperor Shah Jahan
- Built in: 1633 CE
- Cost: Not documented in available sources
- Built for: A royal bathing complex (hammam) with adjoining private retiring chambers (Khilwat Khana)

2. Construction Details

- Contents: The Khilwat Khana grouping encompasses the Kala Burj and Lal Burj pavilions
- Materials/technique: Not separately documented; very little of the original hammam structure survives today, according to heritage surveys

3. Historical Background

- Unlike many other structures in the fort, the Shahi Hammam has not survived well - heritage surveys note that very little of the original bath structure remains today, in sharp contrast to the well-preserved Sheesh Mahal and Naulakha Pavilion nearby.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- The hammam's poor survival makes it one of the more instructive "loss" stories in the fort - a reminder that not every Mughal structure has come down to us intact, even within an otherwise well-preserved quadrangle.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Of everything Shah Jahan built in this corner of the fort in 1633, the bathhouse - once a place of steam, water channels and quiet retreat - is the part that time has been least kind to; today it survives mostly as a name and a location rather than a building you can walk through.